Redlynch State College

Psychology

IA2

Student name	
Student number	
Teacher	
Issued	19/02/2026
Due date	30/04/2026

Marking summary

Criterion	Marks allocated	Provisional marks
Forming	5	
Finding	5	
Analysing	5	
Interpreting and Evaluating	5	
Overall	**20**	

Conditions

Technique	Student experiment
Unit/s	Unit 3: Individual thinking
Topic/s	Unit 3 — Topic 3: Memory (15 hours) Unit 3 — Topic 4: Learning (10 hours)
Duration	Approximately 10 hours of class time
Mode / length	Written: Up to 2000 words
Individual / group	Individual
Other	Students can develop their responses in class time and their own time. Students use a practical or simulation performed in class as the basis for their methodology and research question.

Context

In this unit, you have:

- Studied how memory works and factors that affect memory performance.
- Focused on how the environment where learning and recall happen can influence memory.
- Completed a practical experiment replicating parts of the 1998 study by Grant et al.

Purpose of this task: To investigate and evaluate how environmental context affects memory by developing a clear research question, analysing scientific evidence, and presenting justified conclusions, then relating these conclusions back to the memory and learning content from Unit 3.

Audience: This task is designed for Year 12 Psychology students. Your work will be assessed by teachers and external QCAA moderators. The final report should be written as a formal scientific report for an academic audience interested in psychological research.

Relevance: This practical builds on the memory and cognition topics studied in Unit 3, including your practical experience with the Grant et al. replication.

Problem to address: Does the learning environment impact how well people remember information? You will explore this by analysing relevant evidence and extending the investigation.

Task

You must modify (refine, extend, or redirect) an experiment to investigate your own related hypothesis or research question. You may use a practical performed in class, a related simulation, or another practical related to Unit 3 (negotiated with your teacher) as the basis for your methodology and research question.

To complete this task, you must:

- Identify an experiment to modify*
- Develop a research question to be investigated*
- Research relevant scientific background to inform the modification of the research question and methodology
- Conduct a risk assessment and account for risks in the methodology*
- Conduct the experiment*
- Collect relevant qualitative and/or quantitative data to address the research question*
- Process and present the data appropriately
- Analyse the evidence to identify trends, patterns, and relationships

- Analyse the evidence to identify uncertainty and limitations
- Interpret the evidence to draw conclusion/s to the research question
- Evaluate the reliability and validity of the experimental process
- Suggest possible improvements and/or extensions to the experiment
- Communicate your findings in an appropriate scientific genre (a scientific report)

Visual Journal:

- You must maintain a Visual Research Journal throughout the task that documents your research and thinking process step-by-step.
- This journal can include diagrams, mind maps, annotated sources, planning notes, reflections, and photographic evidence of your work.
- The journal supports your final report and is an important tool for authenticating your learning.
- You will submit the Visual Research Journal along with your draft and final report.

* Steps marked with an asterisk may be completed collaboratively in groups. All other elements must be completed individually.

Checkpoints

- ☐ Checkpoint 1: Task issued and experiment identified. Start your Visual Journal (physical scrapbook) with planning, setup, and research question.
- ☐ Checkpoint 2: Conduct the experiment and process data. Document your practical work and data collection visually in your Visual Journal.
- ☐ Checkpoint 3: Analyse and evaluate evidence. Use your Visual Journal to show data patterns and interpretations.
- ☐ Checkpoint 4: Submit draft report electronically via email and Turnitin/QLearn. Bring your Visual Journal to class for teacher review.
- ☐ Checkpoint 5: Receive feedback and reflect in your Visual Journal.
- ☐ Checkpoint 6: Submit final report electronically via email and Turnitin/QLearn. Submit hard copies of both your final report and Visual Journal (scrapbook) to your teacher.

Authentication strategies

- You will be provided class time for task completion.
- Your teacher will observe you completing work in class.
- You will produce sections of the final response under supervised conditions.
- Your teacher will collect copies of your response and monitor at key junctures.

- Your teacher will collect and annotate a draft of up to 2000 words. Any extra length will be given one generalised comment.
- You must acknowledge all sources.
- You must submit a declaration of authenticity signed by both yourself and your care giver.
- You will produce summaries during your response preparation.
- Your teacher will conduct interviews or consultations as you develop the response.
- Your teacher will conduct interviews after submission to clarify or explore aspects of your response.
- Your teacher will compare the responses of students who have worked together in groups.
- Your teacher will ensure class cross-marking occurs.
- When working as part of a group, your individual response is assessed by your individual performance in the assessment technique/task.
- You will use email and Turnitin/QLearn to submit your response.
- You will provide documentation of your progress at Checkpoints 1, 2, 3, 4, and 5 through your Visual Journal, which records your practical work, data collection, analysis, and reflections.
- Your Visual Research Journal must be submitted with your draft and final submission of the task as an authentication requirement.

Scaffolding

Title & Rationale	Choose a clear, specific title related to your research question. Write a rationale explaining why you chose this topic and its relevance to memory and learning with reference to the original study.
Research Question	Develop a focused research question that guides your investigation.
Research and Planning	Provide a clear description of the original model/theory you are investigating (e.g., memory or retrieval theory). Justify how you refined, redirected, or extended the experiment /practical/simulation. Identify your IV, DV, population, and context. Include details of experimental design, sampling, participants (anonymity maintained), and risk management (consent, confidentiality, right to withdraw, risks, debriefing).
Methodology	Describe your experimental design and procedure clearly, including how you modified the original/practical method.
	Collect and record raw data systematically in tables. Note

Data Collection	any abnormalities or unusual results.
Data Analysis	Calculate descriptive statistics (mean, median, SD, IQR, SE, etc.). Present data visually with properly labelled tables and figures. Discuss relevance of calculations (e.g., what does SD tell you about variability?).
Statistical Testing	Choose and justify an appropriate statistical test. Report the test and p-values accurately. Interpret whether results are significant.
Limitations & Validity	Analyse limitations of your data and evaluate the reliability and validity of your experiment clearly and separately.
Conclusions	Draw justified conclusions that directly answer your research question. Link conclusions to statistical results and previous research.
Improvements & Extensions	Suggest practical improvements or extensions for future research.
References	Include full APA 7th edition citations for all sources used. Ensure every reference is cited in the text.
Visual Journal	Maintain a detailed Visual Journal throughout the investigation, documenting planning, data collection, analysis, and reflections. Use diagrams, photos, notes, and reflections to support your written report.
Communication	Proofread your report carefully. Write in third person, past tense. Be concise and clear. Ensure all references are cited properly in APA7 format.

Instrument-specific marking guide (IA2)

Forming	Marks
The student response has the following characteristics:	
• a considered rationale for the experiment • justified modifications to the methodology • a specific and relevant research question • a methodology that enables the collection of sufficient and relevant data • appropriate use of genre and referencing conventions	4–5
• a reasonable rationale for the experiment • feasible modifications to the methodology • a relevant research question • a methodology that enables the collection of relevant data • use of basic genre and referencing conventions	2–3
• a vague or irrelevant rationale for the experiment • inappropriate modifications to the methodology • an inappropriate research question • a methodology that causes the collection of insufficient and irrelevant data • inadequate use of genre and referencing conventions.	1
The student response does not match any of the descriptors above.	0

Finding	Marks
The student response has the following characteristics:	
• considered management of risks/ethical issues/environmental issues • collection of sufficient and relevant raw data • fluent and concise use of scientific language and representations	4–5
• management of risks/ethical issues/environmental issues • collection of relevant raw data • competent use of scientific language and representations	2–3
• inadequate management of risks/ethical issues/environmental issues • collection of insufficient and irrelevant raw data • simplistic use of language and representations.	1
The student response does not match any of the descriptors above.	0

Analysing	Marks
The student response has the following characteristics:	
• correct and relevant processing of data • thorough identification of relevant trends/patterns/relationships • thorough and appropriate identification of the uncertainty and limitations of evidence	4–5
• basic processing of data • identification of obvious trends/patterns/relationships • basic identification of uncertainty and/or limitations of evidence	2–3
• incorrect or irrelevant processing of data • identification of incorrect or irrelevant trends/patterns/relationships • incorrect or insufficient identification of uncertainty and limitations of evidence.	1
The student response does not match any of the descriptors above.	0

Interpreting and Evaluating	Marks
The student response has the following characteristics:	
• justified conclusion/s linked to the research question • justified discussion of the reliability and validity of the experimental process • suggested improvements and extensions to the experiment that are logically derived from the analysis of evidence	4–5
• reasonable conclusion/s relevant to the research question • reasonable description of the reliability and/or validity of the experimental process • suggested improvements and/or extensions to the experiment that are related to the analysis of evidence	2–3
• inappropriate or irrelevant conclusion/s • cursory or simplistic statements about the reliability and validity of the experimental process • ineffective or irrelevant suggestions.	1
The student response does not match any of the descriptors above.	0